Analysis of Radiative Heat Transfer Between Two Infinitely Long Cylinders in an Eccentric Arrangement

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Assignment statement

Inside an infinite cylinder A of radius $R = 1$ m, maintained at constant temperature $\vartheta_A = 30$ °C, a second, smaller infinite cylinder B of radius r, ($r < R$), is placed, which is also maintained on constant temperature $\vartheta_B > \vartheta_A$. Both cylinders are diffuse-gray bodies with emissivity coefficients ε_A and ε_B and the space between them is a vacuum.

If the cylinders are arranged concentrically or if both are black bodies, a heat flux density on the surface of cylinder B is uniform, however, if both cylinders are diffuse-gray bodies and the smaller cylinder B is placed at distance d, $0 < d < R - r$ from the centre of cylinder A, heat flux density on the cylinder B is not uniformly distributed.

The task is to analyse the deviation from uniform surface flux density when the cylinder B is placed eccentrically within the cylinder A, using a view factor method.

Temperature notation: ϑ_A and ϑ_B in the assignment are written as T_A and T_B in the report.

The following is required

(a) For a selected combination of parameters r, d, and ϑ_B, analyse the effect of discretizing the surfaces of cylinders A and B into equal segments (the number of elements on cylinders A and B need not be equal) on the deviation from uniform surface flux density on cylinder B. The analysis must include the derivation of the appropriate thermodynamic model for radiative heat transfer.

(b) Using the same thermodynamic model and the selected discretization, analyse the influence of parameters r, d, and ϑ_B, on the deviation from uniform surface density of cylinder B.

(c) Supplement all analyses with appropriate descriptions, diagrams, and commentary, and compare the results with analytical solutions, if find appropriate.

Objective and numerical scope

Quantify deviation from uniform net heat-flux density on cylinder B using view factors, derive the thermodynamic model, select a surface discretization, and study r, d and T_B. Descriptions, diagrams, discussion, raw results and the corresponding program code accompany the analyses.

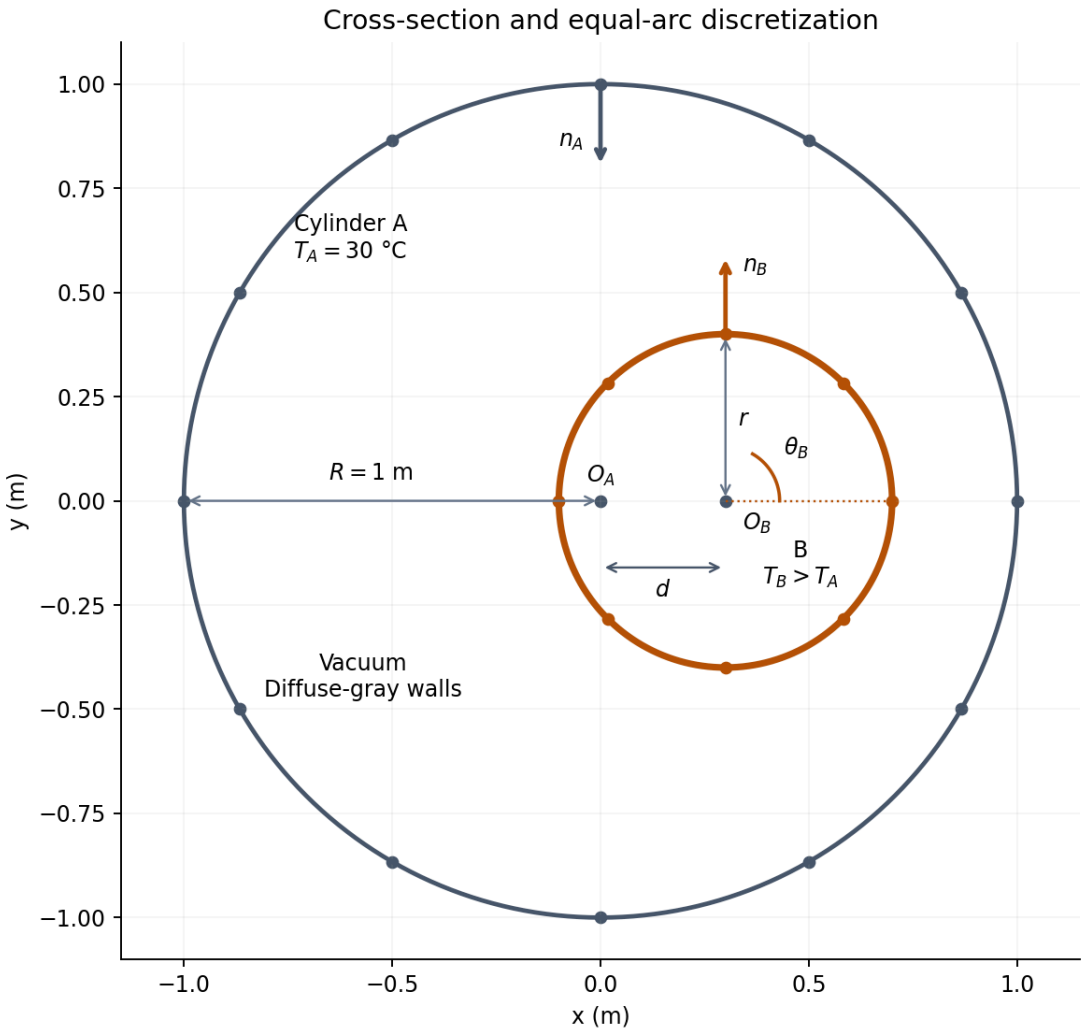


Figure: working geometry. The displayed 12/8 segment boundaries illustrate the idea of equal-arc discretization; suitable calculation counts are assessed in the refinement study below.

Symbols in the diagram

Symbol	Meaning
R	Radius of outer cylinder A: the distance from its center to its wall (m).
r	Radius of inner cylinder B: the distance from its center to its surface (m).
O_A, O_B	Center points of cylinders A and B.
d	Distance between the two centers, O_A and O_B (m).
T_A, T_B	Surface temperatures of cylinders A and B.
θ_B	Angular position of a point on B, measured counterclockwise from the right. 0° = right, 90° = top, 180° = left, 270° = bottom. It identifies where the local flux is calculated.
n_A	Surface normal on A: a direction perpendicular to its wall, pointing inward into the gap.
n_B	Surface normal on B: a direction perpendicular to its surface, pointing outward into the gap.

The normal arrows show surface orientation. Their lengths do not represent heat-flux magnitude. The angle θ_B labels a position; it does not indicate cylinder rotation.

Part (a): thermodynamic model

Assignment requirement (a)

> For a selected combination of parameters r, d, and ϑ_B, analyse the effect of discretizing the surfaces of cylinders A and B into equal segments (the number of elements on cylinders A and B need not be equal) on the deviation from uniform surface flux density on cylinder B. The analysis must include the derivation of the appropriate thermodynamic model for radiative heat transfer.

1. Physical assumptions and geometry

Term	Plain meaning
Infinitely long	We exclude effects near the ends of the cylinders.
Isothermal	Every location on a given cylinder has the same temperature. A and B can have different temperatures.
Prescribed temperature	The temperature is a specified input and is maintained at that value.
Opaque	Radiation cannot pass through the cylinder wall.
Diffuse	Emission and reflection follow a diffuse angular distribution, rather than mirror-like reflection.
Gray	Emissivity is treated as independent of radiation wavelength.
Uniform emissivity	A given cylinder has the same emissivity everywhere around its surface.
Temperature-independent emissivity	We keep emissivity unchanged when temperature changes.

Cylinder A has prescribed radius $R = 1$ m and temperature $T_A = 303.15$ K (30 °C). Cylinder B has radius $0 < r < R$ and prescribed $T_B > T_A$. Both surfaces are infinitely long, isothermal, opaque, diffuse-gray bodies with uniform, temperature-independent emissivities. The gap is a vacuum: only surface-to-surface radiation is included. There is no transient temperature equation because both temperatures are prescribed.

The center of A is $O_A = (0, 0)$. The center of B is $O_B = (x_B, 0)$, where $x_B = +d$ on the right or $-d$ on the left. The center distance $d = |x_B|$ satisfies $0 < d < R - r$ for eccentric cases. The concentric case $d = 0$ is retained as a numerical reference. Normalized eccentricity is $e = d/(R - r)$. Angles on B are measured counterclockwise from the fixed positive x-axis: 0° right, 90° top, 180° left and 270° bottom. Mirroring the position mirrors the flux profile without changing scalar heat rates or nonuniformity measures.

2. Surface discretization and units

Divide A and B into N_A and N_B equal angular arcs, allowing different counts on the two surfaces. Retain their exact circular geometry and approximate radiosity as constant on each arc. The angular widths and areas per unit axial length are

$$\Delta\theta_A = \frac{2\pi}{N_A}, \qquad \Delta\theta_B = \frac{2\pi}{N_B}, \qquad a_A = R\Delta\theta_A, \qquad a_B = r\Delta\theta_B. \tag{1}$$

The a_i have units m^2 per m of axial length (equivalently m). Flux density q_i has units $\mathrm{W/m}^2$; heat rate per axial length Q' has units W/m. These are different quantities, particularly when radius changes. The reported local numerical flux is an arc average, rather than an exact pointwise value.

Code: `radiation.py` defines the circular geometry and equal-arc areas used in (1).

3. Derivation of the diffuse-gray energy balance

For an opaque gray surface, absorptivity equals emissivity. Of the irradiation G_i arriving at arc i, the absorbed fraction is $\epsilon_i G_i$ and the reflected fraction is $(1-\epsilon_i)G_i$. Thermal emission is $\epsilon_i \sigma T_i^4$, where $\sigma = 5.670374419 \times 10^{-8}$ W/(m^2 K^4). Temperatures in this expression are in kelvin.

The total outgoing radiosity is therefore

$$J_i = \underbrace{\epsilon_i \sigma T_i^4}_{\text{emitted by the surface}} + \underbrace{(1-\epsilon_i) G_i}_{\text{reflected incoming radiation}} . \tag{2}$$

The view factor F_{ij} is the fraction of diffuse radiation leaving arc i that reaches arc j, accounting for visibility and obstruction by B. Reciprocity gives the incident-radiation relation

$$G_i = \sum_j F_{ij} J_j. \tag{3}$$

Substituting (3) into (2):

$$J_i = \epsilon_i \sigma T_i^4 + (1-\epsilon_i) \underbrace{\sum_j F_{ij} J_j}_{G_i}. \tag{4}$$

Rearranging (4):

$$J_i - (1-\epsilon_i) \sum_j F_{ij} J_j = \epsilon_i \sigma T_i^4. \tag{5}$$

Equation (5) is written for every surface arc i. The equations are **coupled** because the outgoing radiation from one arc depends on radiation leaving other arcs. Radiation leaving B reaches A; some can be reflected back toward B and reflected again. These repeated exchanges link the unknown radiosities, so they must be solved together.

The equations are **linear in the unknown radiosities** J_j: these unknowns appear only to the first power, multiplied by known coefficients. The prescribed temperatures T_i are known inputs, even though they appear to the fourth power.

Matrix form

Collecting (5) for all surface arcs gives (6). Here I is the identity matrix, F contains the view factors, $\mathcal{E} = \mathrm{diag}(\epsilon_i)$ stores the emissivities on its diagonal, and $\mathbf{J}$ is the list of unknown radiosities:

$$[I - (I - \mathcal{E})F]\,\mathbf{J} = \mathcal{E}\sigma\mathbf{T}^4. \tag{6}$$

After solving (6), irradiation follows from (3), and the net outward flux is

$$q_i = \epsilon_i(\sigma T_i^4 - G_i) = J_i - G_i. \tag{7}$$

Positive q_i means net heat leaves the body; the hotter B has positive net outward flux. Cylinder A absorbs the net heat transferred from B. Using areas per unit axial length,

$$Q'_B = \sum_{i \in B} a_i q_i, \qquad Q'_A = \sum_{i \in A} a_i q_i, \qquad Q'_A + Q'_B = 0. \tag{8}$$

Diffuse-gray radiosity and irradiation are described in the COMSOL surface-radiation theory reference. The sign convention here is positive outward.

Code: In `radiation.py`, `solve_radiation` solves (6), evaluates irradiation with (3), and calculates net flux with (7). `RadiationResult.metrics` evaluates the heat rates and energy balance in (8).

4. View factors for infinitely long cylinders

Symbols in equations (9) and (10)

Symbol	Meaning
i, j	Labels for the emitting arc and receiving arc.
p_i, p_j	Points on the emitting arc i and receiving arc j.
ρ	Distance between the two points in the cross-section (m).
z	Separation between the points along the cylinder axis, perpendicular to the cross-section (m).
β_i, β_j	Orientation: angles in the cross-section between the connecting line and the surface normals pointing into the vacuum.
$V(p_i, p_j)$	Visibility: 1 when the points have an unobstructed connection and face each other; 0 otherwise.
a_i	Area of arc i per unit axial length (m^2/m).
F_{ij}	Fraction of diffuse radiation leaving arc i that directly reaches arc j.
ds_i, ds_j	Infinitesimal (arbitrarily small) arc-length elements on arcs i and j (m), summed by the double integral.

The three-dimensional diffuse exchange kernel is $\cos\theta_i \cos\theta_j / (\pi s^2)$, where s is the full distance between the points and $s^2 = \rho^2 + z^2$. Each projection of a transverse surface normal contributes ρ/s. Integration over the infinite axial direction yields the following result. Equation (9) accounts for receiving points along the entire cylinder length when calculating the view factor.

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \frac{\rho^2}{\pi(\rho^2 + z^2)^2}\, dz = \frac{1}{2\rho}. \tag{9}$$

Using (9), the view-factor exchange per unit axial length is

$$a_i F_{ij} = \int_{\text{arc } i} \int_{\text{arc } j} V(p_i, p_j) \frac{\cos\beta_i \cos\beta_j}{2\rho}\, ds_j\, ds_i. \tag{10}$$

Cylinder A has inward-facing vacuum normals; B has outward-facing normals. The kernel is symmetric, giving reciprocity $a_i F_{ij} = a_j F_{ji}$. B is convex and has no self-view. A is concave and can see other parts of itself, including part of the same finite arc.

Equation (11) is used to **calculate contributions from ranges of directions** at a fixed source point when evaluating (10).

For a source point, let ϕ be emission direction relative to its vacuum-facing normal. Integrating the axial direction gives the directional weight $\cos\phi/2$ on $-\pi/2 < \phi < \pi/2$. Divide this emitting half-plane at bearings to receiver-arc endpoints and tangent directions to B. The first receiver is unchanged within each resulting interval. Its weight is evaluated exactly as

$$\int_{\phi_1}^{\phi_2} \frac{\cos\phi}{2}\, d\phi = \frac{\sin\phi_2 - \sin\phi_1}{2}. \tag{11}$$

A midpoint ray identifies the first intersected receiver in each interval. Tangent directions account for the shadow cast by B. Average the resulting directional factors over each source arc using adaptive Gauss-Kronrod quadrature (`scipy.integrate.quad_vec`, maximum norm). The integration tolerance controls this numerical integration and is assessed separately from the surface segment counts in the discretization study.

Code: `radiation.py`, function `calculate_view_factors`, implements the view factors, visibility and adaptive source-arc integration. Integration tolerance is a chosen numerical setting for evaluating this integral, rather than a physical input or another radiation equation.

No row normalization, symmetrization or smoothing is applied to hide integration residuals. For this closed enclosure, checks include:

- Nonnegativity, $F_{ij} \geq 0$ **(a radiation fraction cannot be negative)**.
- Closure, $\sum_j F_{ij} = 1$ **(all fractions leaving a patch must add to 1, or 100%, because the enclosure is closed)**.
- Reciprocity, $a_i F_{ij} = a_j F_{ji}$ **(the area-weighted geometrical exchange is consistent in both directions)**.

Passing these checks does not guarantee an accurate flux distribution around B. Accuracy is assessed by refining the surface discretization in the next section.

5. Measuring departure from uniform surface flux

Equation (12) first calculates the mean flux around B, $\bar{q}_B$. It is area-weighted, meaning larger surface pieces contribute proportionally more.

Then it calculates each segment's percentage departure from that mean:

$$\bar{q}_B = \frac{\sum_{i\in B} a_i q_i}{\sum_{i\in B} a_i}, \qquad \delta_i = 100\frac{q_i - \bar{q}_B}{|\bar{q}_B|}. \tag{12}$$

Here, B is divided into equal-area arcs, so its area-weighted mean is the ordinary average of the segment fluxes.

The two reported relative nonuniformity measures are

$$D_{\max} = \max_{i\in B} |\delta_i|, \qquad D_{pp} = 100\frac{q_{\max} - q_{\min}}{|\bar{q}_B|}. \tag{13}$$

Both are percentages. Differences between these metrics on two meshes are expressed in **percentage points**. Relative nonuniformity is undefined at effectively zero mean flux. Assignment cases use $T_B > T_A$ and have positive mean flux.

Code: `radiation.py`, property `RadiationResult.metrics`, computes the mean flux, $D_{\max}$ and D_{pp} from the original segment-average fluxes. Comparing two solutions later uses separate numerical formulas (C1) and (C2), introduced in (a) Discretization.

Uniformity means that the angular flux equals the current surface mean everywhere. Comparing against a separate concentric calculation answers a different question and is not used as the definition of nonuniformity here.

6. Temperature dependence and interpretation

With fixed geometry and emissivities, the radiosity system is linear in σT_A^4 and σT_B^4. A closed isothermal enclosure has zero net flux, so the model implies

$$q_B(\theta) = \sigma(T_B^4 - T_A^4)\, h(\theta; r, d, R, \epsilon_A, \epsilon_B). \tag{14}$$

The function h describes the angular pattern produced by geometry and surface properties. The temperature factor scales its magnitude.

Changing T_B scales absolute flux but leaves the normalized angular profile unchanged under these assumptions. This model consequence is checked using the six numerical temperature cases in part (b).

Code: `run_parameter_studies.py` runs those six temperatures using the same solver. `run_discretization.py`, function `supporting_checks`, also checks temperature scaling at the starting and largest-offset arrangements.

Local net flux depends on both emission and irradiation from the whole enclosure, including diffuse reflections. It is not determined by local gap distance alone. The narrow-gap and wide-gap trends stated in the report refer to the calculated gray-surface cases.

7. Numerical checks and limits

- Closure, reciprocity, nonnegativity and enclosure energy balance check numerical consistency.
- Equal-temperature equilibrium and left/right reflection symmetry are tested at the public solver interfaces.
- Independent A/B surface refinement and separate integration-tolerance refinement establish finite-mesh stability for the stated study cases.
- Very narrow gaps, other radii or different emissivities can require additional refinement. A successful solve is not an accuracy guarantee for arbitrary inputs.
- Infinite isothermal cylinders omit end effects, participating media, material temperature dependence and transient energy storage. Interactive motion shows successive prescribed steady states.

Code: The physical solver checks are in `tests/test_solver.py`; the recorded-study and data-integrity checks are in `tests/test_studies.py`. The surface-refinement evidence is generated by `run_discretization.py`.

Part (a): discretization selection

Assignment requirement (a)

> For a selected combination of parameters r, d, and ϑ_B, analyse the effect of discretizing the surfaces of cylinders A and B into equal segments (the number of elements on cylinders A and B need not be equal) on the deviation from uniform surface flux density on cylinder B. The analysis must include the derivation of the appropriate thermodynamic model for radiative heat transfer.

Working parameters

Parameter	Baseline	Reason
Outer radius R	1 m	Prescribed by the assignment
Outer temperature T_A	30 C	Prescribed by the assignment
Inner radius r	0.4 m	Leaves room to vary radius and offset independently
Offset d	0.3 m	e = 0.5; minimum gap 0.3 m, maximum gap 0.9 m
Inner temperature T_B	200 C	A working hot-cylinder case above T_A
Emissivities epsilon_A / epsilon_B	0.6 / 0.8	Explicit gray-surface working assumptions, allowing diffuse reflections; no particular material is claimed

Final one-parameter sweeps: e = 0, 0.15, 0.30, 0.45, 0.60, 0.75, 0.90 at r = 0.4 m; r = 0.2, 0.3, 0.4, 0.5, 0.6 m at fixed d = 0.3 m; T_B = 60 to 400 C at baseline geometry. Fix both emissivities throughout. The minimum gap among these geometry points is 0.06 m. The concentric point is a numerical boundary check and a useful starting point for the eccentricity sweep.

How results from two calculations are compared

This is a numerical comparison after the radiation equations have been solved. It defines the **Profile change (%)** column; it is separate from the physical model in equations (1)–(14).

Call the first calculation c and the more resolved calculation f. For a surface-refinement comparison, f has more segments. For an integration-tolerance comparison, both segment counts stay fixed and f uses the tighter tolerance.

Let $\tilde{q}_c$ and $\tilde{q}_f$ be the two B-flux curves obtained by straight-line, periodic interpolation of the calculated segment averages at their midpoint angles. Compare them at the same positions, $\theta_k = 360^\circ k/4096$, for $k = 0, \ldots, 4095$:

$$C_q = 100 \frac{\max\limits_{k=0,\ldots,4095} |\tilde{q}_c(\theta_k) - \tilde{q}_f(\theta_k)|}{|\bar{q}_{B,f}|}. \tag{C1}$$

In words: find the largest separation between the two flux curves, divide by the more resolved calculation's mean flux from equation (12), and multiply by 100. This gives **Profile change (%)**.

The 4096 angles are a chosen comparison setting. They add no surface segments or new radiation solutions. Periodic interpolation connects the last angular values back to the first across 360° and 0°.

The other two change columns use the $D_{\max}$ and D_{pp} values from equation (13), calculated from each solution's original segment averages:

$$\Delta D_{\max} = |D_{\max,c} - D_{\max,f}|, \qquad \Delta D_{pp} = |D_{pp,c} - D_{pp,f}|. \tag{C2}$$

These changes are measured in **percentage points (pp)**. Small changes support stability under refinement; they do not give a guaranteed bound on the error relative to the exact solution.

Code: `run_discretization.py`, function `compare`, implements (C1), (C2), the 4096 comparison angles and periodic interpolation. The same function is used for the independent surface checks, integration-tolerance checks, 12-arrangement check and extra smallest-gap check.

Independent baseline refinement

Code: `run_discretization.py`, function `independent`, runs the surface and integration-tolerance cases using `radiation.py`.

The outer surface was refined through 24, 48, 96 and 192 segments with the inner surface held at 128. The inner surface was refined through 16, 32, 64 and 128 segments with the outer surface held at 192. This separates their effects; both surfaces were not simply increased together.

Refinement	D_max change (percentage points)	D_pp change (percentage points)
outer_24_128 to outer_48_128	0.051272	0.064188
outer_48_128 to outer_96_128	0.012871	0.016035
outer_96_128 to outer_192_128	0.003233	0.004028
inner_192_16 to inner_192_32	0.140154	0.181613
inner_192_32 to inner_192_64	0.035871	0.046180
inner_192_64 to outer_192_128	0.009021	0.011595

The inner 16-to-32 refinement fails the 0.1 percentage-point criterion. Finer meshes stabilize. Although the baseline alone permits smaller grids, the choice must also cover the larger offsets in part (b).

Qualification across the study points

Accept changes below 0.5% in the maximum difference of interpolated flux profiles, and below 0.1 percentage points in both D_max and D_pp. Normalize profile differences by the refined grid's mean inner flux. Periodic interpolation uses a shared 4096-angle grid and segment averages; it is a comparison method, not an exact pointwise solution.

Each of the 12 distinct geometry points was compared at 96/128 and 192/256 segments. All pass the three criteria.

Code: `run_discretization.py`, function `qualify`, runs these arrangements and compares both meshes using `compare`.

Study point	e	Profile change (%)	D_max change (pp)	D_pp change (pp)
baseline	0.500	0.005695	0.005491	0.006929
eccentricity_0	0.000	0.000000	0.000000	0.000000
eccentricity_1	0.150	0.000800	0.000787	0.001313
eccentricity_2	0.300	0.002126	0.002070	0.002994
eccentricity_3	0.450	0.004494	0.004342	0.005641
eccentricity_4	0.600	0.009133	0.008783	0.010556
eccentricity_5	0.750	0.019427	0.018657	0.021227
eccentricity_6	0.900	0.047166	0.045451	0.049711
radius_0	0.375	0.001987	0.001891	0.002530
radius_1	0.429	0.003578	0.003429	0.004453
radius_3	0.600	0.008398	0.008140	0.009991
radius_4	0.750	0.011441	0.011134	0.013361

Why the inner grid was increased from 64 to 128

At e = 0.9, the coarser 96/64 mesh passes comparison with 192/128. Its D_pp nevertheless differs from the additional 384/256 reference by 0.102032 percentage points, just above the threshold. Increasing the inner grid to 128 reduces the difference to 0.059172 percentage points and the profile difference to 0.056176%. This additional check avoids relying on a marginal first comparison.

Code: `run_discretization.py`, function `worst_case`, runs these additional resolutions at the same smallest-gap arrangement.

Integration and temperature checks

At 96/64 baseline resolution, tightening source integration from 1e-6 through 1e-9 changes the nonuniformity metrics by less than 2e-9 percentage points between successive tolerances. At the selected 96/128 resolution, a 1e-8 versus 1e-9 check was also run at the baseline and at e = 0.9.

- baseline: profile change 1.658e-11%; D_pp change 1.274e-11 percentage points.
- high_eccentricity: profile change 2.629e-10%; D_pp change 2.937e-11 percentage points.

Temperature checks at 60, 200 and 400 C, for both baseline and e = 0.9 geometry, leave the normalized nonuniformity unchanged to approximately 2e-12 percentage points. This agrees with the linear fixed-emissivity model: temperature scales absolute flux through the difference in fourth powers. It does not justify temperature-independent results if material emissivity varies with temperature.

Across the selected-mesh qualification and reference cases, the maximum relative enclosure energy imbalance is 4.470e-12, maximum row-closure residual is 7.883e-15, and maximum scaled reciprocity residual is 5.773e-08.

Decision based on the refinement evidence

Use **96 equal angular segments on cylinder A and 128 on cylinder B**, with source-arc integration tolerance **1e-8**, for the documented final parameter-study points. The interactive simulation uses a coarser 24/32 mesh for speed and is not part of the reported results.

Code: `finalize_discretization.py` checks the recorded evidence and saves the selected settings. `plot_discretization.py` draws the selection-evidence figure.

Selected-mesh baseline result

- Mean inner flux: 1549.473679 W/m^2.
- D_max: 4.734188%.
- D_pp: 8.206598%.
- Heat from B per unit length: 3894.252103 W/m.

Scope and reproducibility

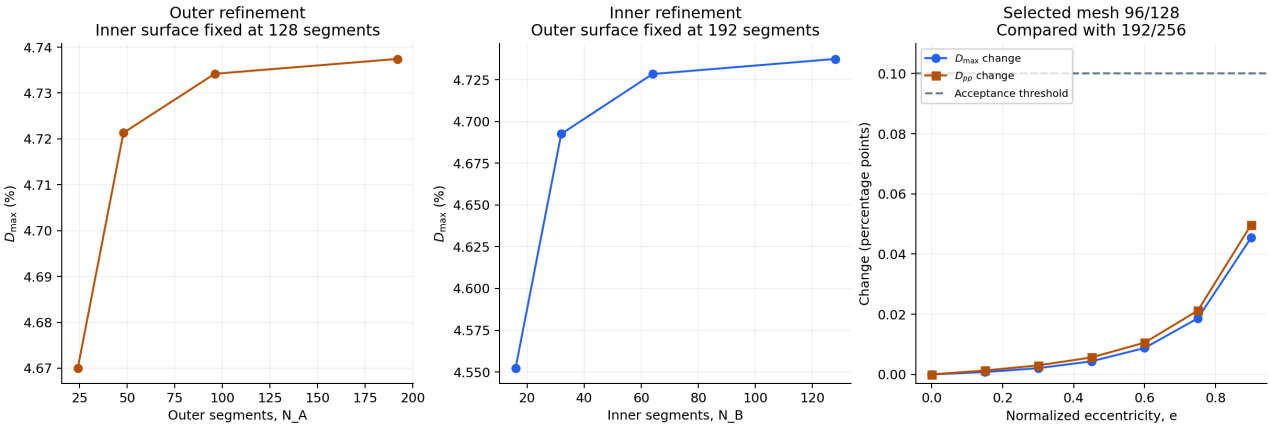
The selection is supported at the specified geometry points with emissivities 0.6/0.8. It is not a rigorous error bound, a proof for all continuous intermediate values, or qualification of arbitrary radius/offset/emissivity combinations. The site remains interactive; user-selected cases outside the documented points can be checked using independent refinement.

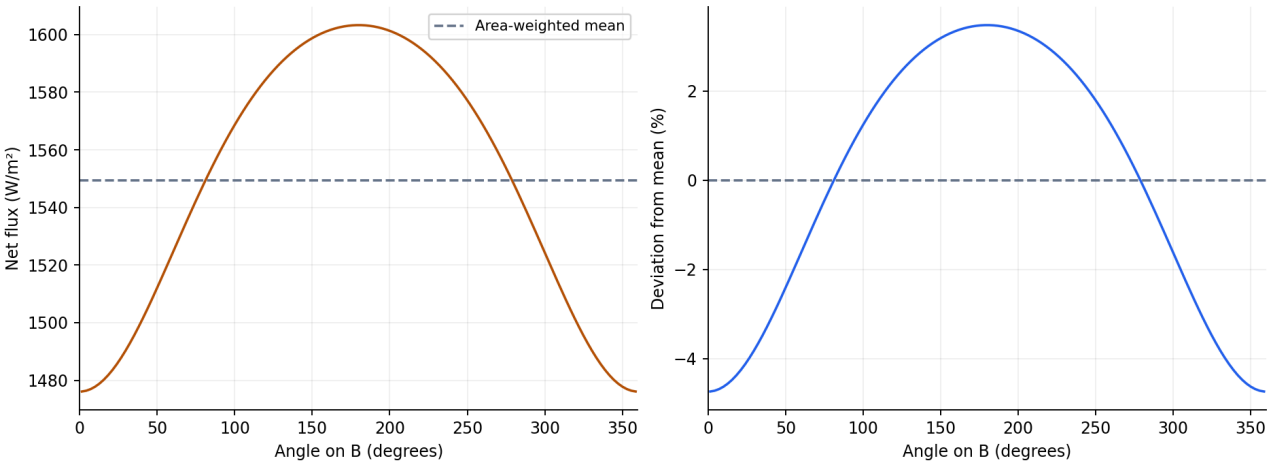
The numerical scope follows the requested assignment requirements. The interpretation of all three required parameter studies is presented in PARAMETERS.md.

Run the following from the repository directory (local caches in tmp/ make repeat runs faster):

```
python scripts/run_discretization.py --stage independent
python scripts/run_discretization.py --stage worst-case
python scripts/run_discretization.py --stage qualify --outer 96 --inner 128
python scripts/run_discretization.py --stage support --outer 96 --inner 128
python scripts/finalize_discretization.py
python scripts/plot_discretization.py
```

Raw case tables, angular profiles, comparison tables, source fingerprints, and selected settings are stored in results/discretization/. The completed parameter studies use this selected mesh; see PARAMETERS.md and REPORT.md.





Part (b): influence of physical parameters

Assignment requirement (b)

> Using the same thermodynamic model and the selected discretization, analyse the influence of parameters r, d, and ϑ_B, on the deviation from uniform surface density of cylinder B.

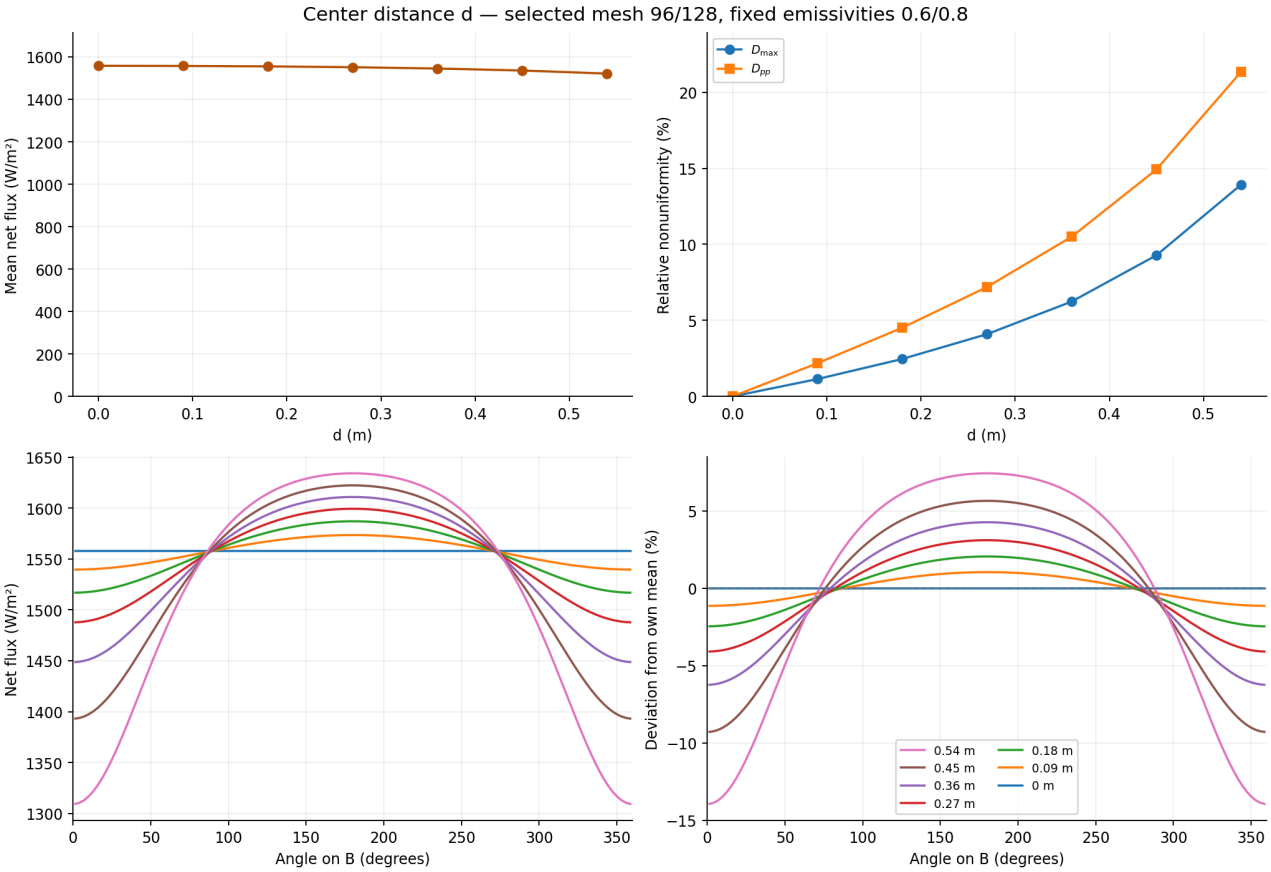
All cases use N_A = 96, N_B = 128, source integration tolerance 1e-8, R = 1 m, T_A = 30 C, epsilon_A = 0.6 and epsilon_B = 0.8. Only the named parameter changes within each study. All reported q values are segment averages.

Code: `run_parameter_studies.py` runs the three studies with the selected settings using `radiation.py`. `plot_studies.py` generates these figures and the written report; `study_data.py` checks the recorded data and prepares the commentary.

Center distance d

At fixed r = 0.4 m and T_B = 200 °C, increasing d from 0.00 to 0.54 m increases D_max from approximately zero to 13.933%. D_pp reaches 21.358%, while mean flux changes from 1558.02 to 1521.27 W/m^2. The concentric point is a numerical reference; the other points are eccentric cases. For these gray-surface parameters, the narrow-gap side loses less net heat per area than the wide-gap side. A has uniform temperature but nonuniform radiosity because it also reflects the nonuniform irradiation from B. In these cases the near side of B receives more returning irradiation, reducing its net outward flux through q = epsilon_B (sigma T_B^4 - G_B). This is a coupled enclosure result, rather than a universal rule based on distance alone.

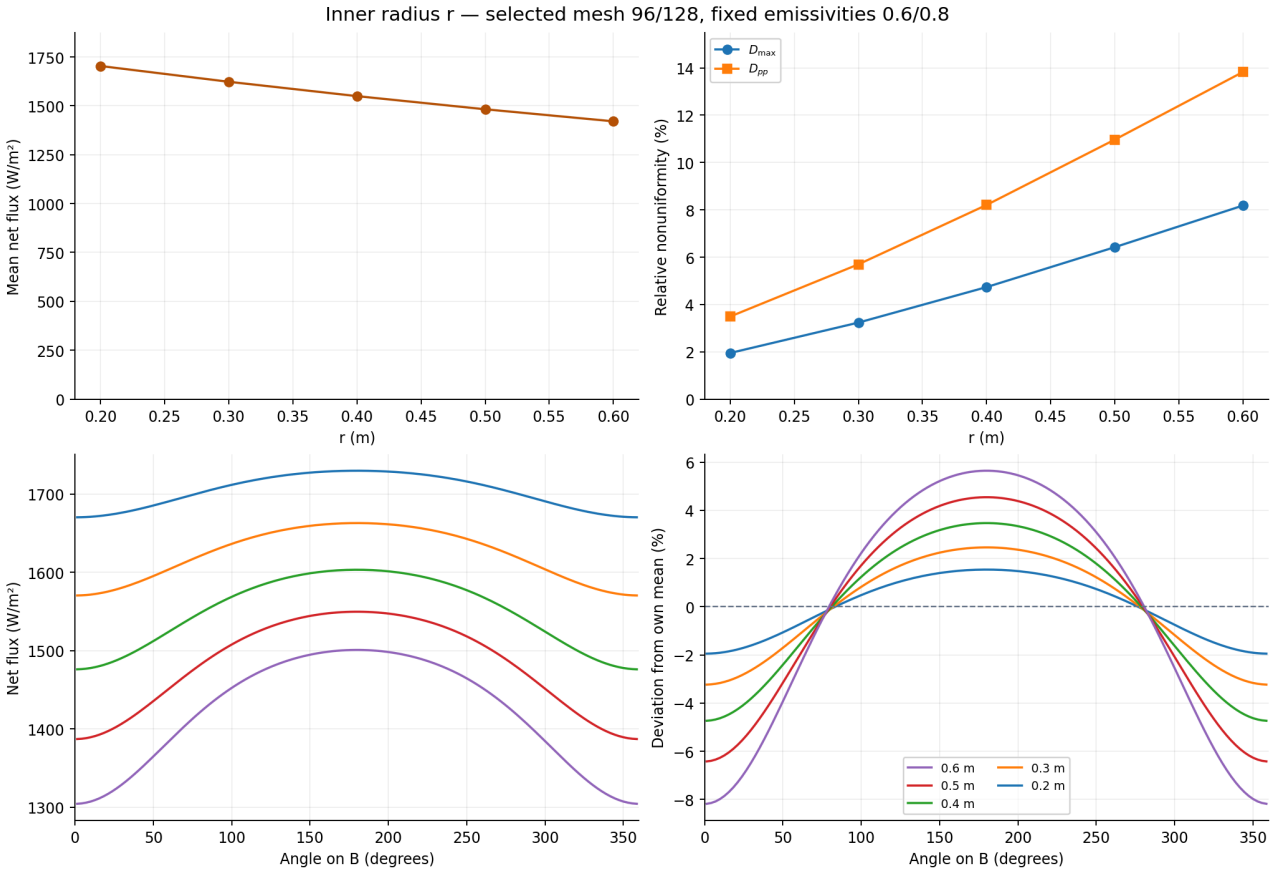
r (m)	d (m)	T_B (C)	Mean q (W/m^2)	D_max (%)	D_pp (%)	Q'_B (W/m)
0.4	0	200	1558.016783	0.000000	0.000000	3915.723263
0.4	0.09	200	1557.320269	1.138305	2.179610	3913.972733
0.4	0.18	200	1555.150222	2.459528	4.513215	3908.518811
0.4	0.27	200	1551.242856	4.089777	7.192051	3898.698528
0.4	0.36	200	1545.072639	6.237372	10.500921	3883.191083
0.4	0.45	200	1535.673935	9.281182	14.926887	3859.569562
0.4	0.54	200	1521.265304	13.933297	21.358301	3823.356722



Inner radius r

At fixed d = 0.3 m and T_B = 200 °C, increasing r from 0.2 to 0.6 m increases D_max from 1.948% to 8.181%. Mean flux decreases from 1703.45 to 1420.67 W/m^2. The total heat per unit length changes from 2140.62 to 5355.81 W/m because the circumference also changes. Holding d fixed makes normalized eccentricity increase from 0.375 to 0.750; the minimum gap decreases from 0.50 to 0.10 m. These conclusions describe radius variation at fixed center distance, not at fixed normalized eccentricity.

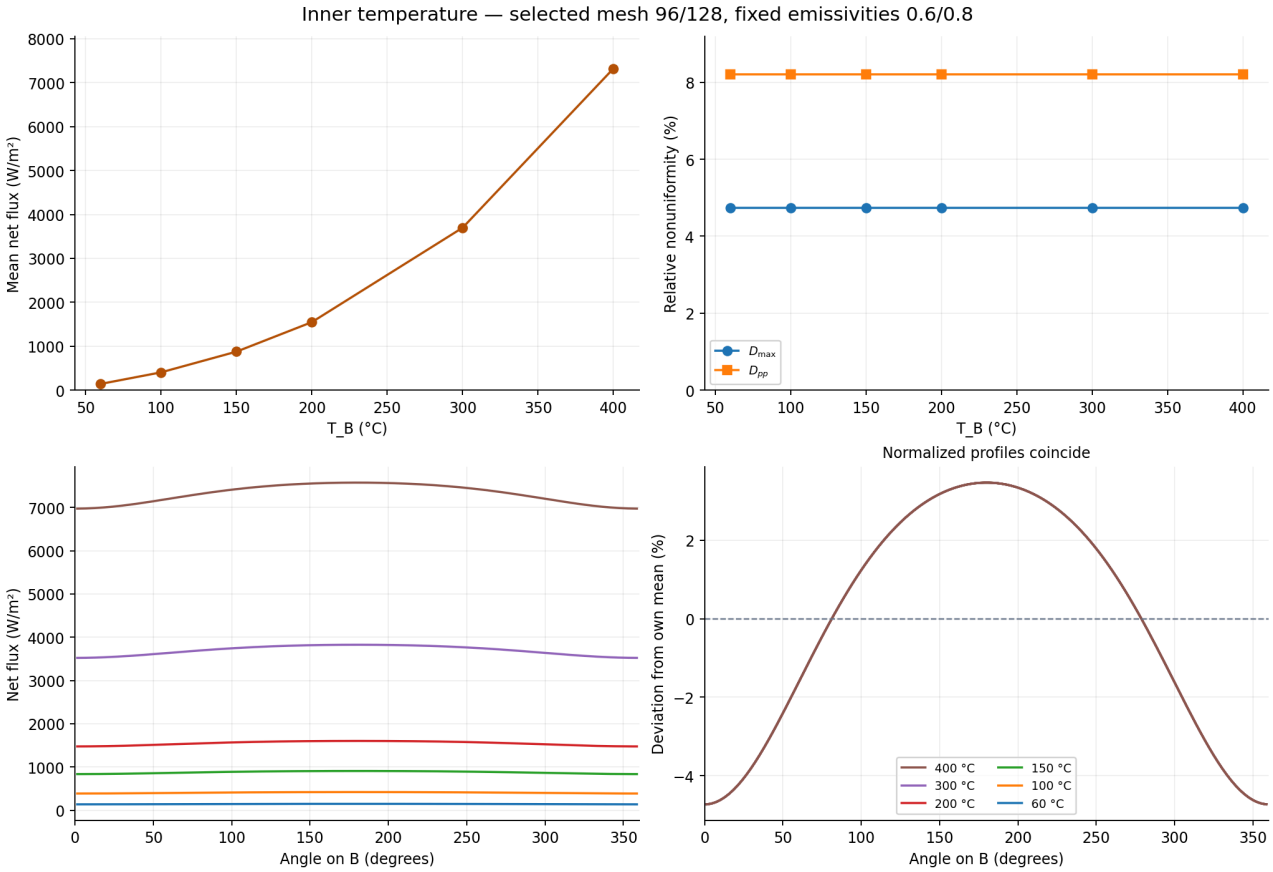
r (m)	d (m)	T_B (C)	Mean q (W/m^2)	D_max (%)	D_pp (%)	Q'_B (W/m)
0.2	0.3	200	1703.454772	1.948488	3.490679	2140.624399
0.3	0.3	200	1622.909791	3.233448	5.696237	3059.112885
0.4	0.3	200	1549.473679	4.734188	8.206598	3894.252103
0.5	0.3	200	1482.288631	6.421594	10.968284	4656.747072
0.6	0.3	200	1420.672289	8.180997	13.827983	5355.808353



Inner temperature

At fixed r = 0.4 m and d = 0.3 m, raising T_B from 60 to 400 °C increases mean flux from 144.00 to 7320.48 W/m^2 (a factor of 50.84). D_max remains 4.734188%: its observed range is 1.18e-12 percentage points. With fixed geometry and temperature-independent emissivities, the linear radiosity equations scale absolute flux with the difference of fourth powers of temperature. The normalized angular shape therefore remains unchanged. This does not apply automatically to materials whose emissivity changes with temperature.

r (m)	d (m)	T_B (C)	Mean q (W/m^2)	D_max (%)	D_pp (%)	Q'_B (W/m)
0.4	0.3	60	144.004152	4.734188	8.206598	361.921909
0.4	0.3	100	406.862619	4.734188	8.206598	1022.557293
0.4	0.3	150	878.070690	4.734188	8.206598	2206.832344
0.4	0.3	200	1549.473679	4.734188	8.206598	3894.252103
0.4	0.3	300	3698.399508	4.734188	8.206598	9295.091780
0.4	0.3	400	7320.483414	4.734188	8.206598	18398.381531



Numerical consistency

Across the 19 baseline/study cases, maximum relative energy imbalance is 1.690e-12, maximum view-factor closure residual is 5.773e-15, and maximum scaled reciprocity residual is 5.605e-08. These are consistency checks; mesh selection also uses finite-refinement comparisons.

Reproduce with `python scripts/run_assignment.py`. Source fingerprints and raw tables are in results/studies/manifest.json, cases.csv and profiles.csv.

Part (c): discussion and conclusions

Assignment requirement (c)

> Supplement all analyses with appropriate descriptions, diagrams, and commentary, and compare the results with analytical solutions, if find appropriate.

1. The diffuse-gray radiosity model produces a nonuniform q profile in the eccentric baseline: mean q = 1549.473679 W/m^2, D_max = 4.734188% and D_pp = 8.206598%.
2. Independent refinement of the two surfaces is necessary: stable total heat alone does not establish resolution of local nonuniformity. The selected 96/128 mesh passes the documented profile and metric-change criteria at all 12 geometry points, with an additional high-eccentricity check.

3. At the stated fixed emissivities, increasing center distance or increasing radius at fixed center distance increases relative nonuniformity over the studied ranges. The two variations change enclosure geometry in different ways.
4. Increasing prescribed inner temperature increases absolute flux, while normalized nonuniformity remains unchanged under the temperature-independent-emissivity model.
5. Interactive motion displays successive steady states, not physical transient heating. Mirroring B across the y-axis mirrors its flux profile without changing scalar heat-rate or nonuniformity measures.

Limitations

The finite-mesh criteria are practical differences between meshes, not rigorous bounds on the exact solution. Qualification applies to the listed geometry points and fixed emissivities. Arbitrary near-contact or different-emissivity explorations need their own convergence assessment. Prescribed isothermal infinite cylinders omit end effects, participating media and transient energy storage.

Code and reproduction

Guide to the calculation scripts

The links below open the corresponding files on GitHub. The same files are included in the downloadable ZIP, so the calculations can also be inspected and run offline.

Calculation or output	Script on GitHub	What it does
Circular geometry, view factors and integration tolerance	radiation.py	Defines the surface arcs and normals; `calculate_view_factors` handles visibility, directional intervals and adaptive source-arc integration.
Radiosity balance, net flux, energy balance, mean flux, D_max and D_pp	radiation.py	`solve_radiation` solves the coupled equations; `RadiationResult.metrics` evaluates the reported measures from the segment-average fluxes.
Surface and tolerance refinement, 4096-angle comparisons, 12 arrangements and extra smallest-gap check	run_discretization.py	Runs the calculation cases; `compare` implements comparison equations (C1) and (C2).
Selecting settings for part (b)	finalize_discretization.py	Checks the recorded evidence and writes the selected settings and discretization report.
Radius, center-distance and temperature studies	run_parameter_studies.py	Runs the three studies with the selected settings and saves their flux profiles and numerical results.
Discretization figure	plot_discretization.py	Draws the selection-evidence figure from recorded results.
Geometry diagram, study figures and written report	plot_studies.py	Creates the figures and report from the recorded calculations and model documentation.
Report-data checks and parameter-study commentary	study_data.py	Checks data integrity and consistency, and prepares the parameter-study descriptions.
Website sections and interactive plots	report_ui.py, app_charts.py	Present the recorded report results, comparison explanations and interactive charts.
Interactive steady-state simulation and surface arrows	streamlit_app.py, flux_plot.py	Solve the user-selected case using `radiation.py` and display its flux. Eight arrow values are interpolated from the calculated segment averages; their drawing scale fits the gap.
Numerical validation	tests/test_solver.py, tests/test_studies.py	Test the solver's physical consistency and the recorded studies' meanings and integrity.
Written report as PDF	build_report_pdf.py	Typesets REPORT.md, including its equations and figures, and prints it to REPORT.pdf.
Reproducing the complete assignment	run_assignment.py	Runs the refinement, selection, parameter-study, figure, report and packaging stages in order.
Downloadable submission package	build_submission.py	Collects the report, figures, results, source and tests into a ZIP with a file-hash manifest.

The downloadable submission package contains this report, all figures and tables used here, the numerical module, study runners, website source, tests, requirements and a file-hash manifest. From its root directory:

```
python -m pip install -r requirements-dev.txt
python -m pytest -q
python scripts/run_assignment.py
python -m streamlit run scripts/streamlit_app.py
```

Numerical solver SHA-256: `d7215049ac5fbece16e4a613b32ec29ed5aaaa28056abb09556b794f455d6efb`.